

Lab: Prompt Engineering, Stakeholder Interviews, and Simulation

Estimated time: 30 minutes

Learning objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Create effective persona-driven prompts to simulate stakeholder conversations
- Conduct structured interviews using AI tools to gather business requirements
- Transform interview insights into organized, actionable requirements

Introduction

This lab focuses on using persona-driven prompts to simulate stakeholder interviews and capture business requirements. You will work with an AI tool like ChatGPT or Claude to practice asking questions, gathering information, and organizing your findings. This skill helps you prepare for real conversations with stakeholders by letting you test and refine your approach in a safe, repeatable way.

You will create interview prompts, simulate a conversation with a stakeholder persona, and turn the results into structured requirements. By the end, you will have a clear process for moving from raw interview data to organized, usable requirements.

Required tools

- Web AI tool (ChatGPT or Claude)

Exercise 1: Build and run your stakeholder interview

In this exercise, you will design an interview prompt, create a stakeholder persona, and conduct a simulated interview. You will practice asking targeted questions and gathering detailed information about a project scenario.

Step 1: Define your project scenario and stakeholder persona

1. Choose a project or business scenario you want to explore (for example: a mobile banking app, a customer service platform, or an e-commerce website).
2. Create a detailed stakeholder persona by identifying:
 - Their role (e.g., Product Manager or Marketing Director)
 - Their responsibilities
 - Their goals for the project
 - Their concerns or constraints

Step 2: Write and test your interview prompt

1. Write a prompt that instructs the AI to act as your chosen stakeholder. Include the persona details in your prompt.

Example:

You are Alex, a Product Manager for a mobile banking app. You care about security and user experience. Please answer my questions about the app's needs and priorities as if you are Alex.



2. Open your web AI tool and paste your prompt to begin the interview.

Step 3: Conduct the interview

1. Ask 3–5 interview questions focusing on:
 - The stakeholder's main goals
 - Key challenges they face
 - Desired outcomes for the project
2. As the AI responds, ask 2–3 follow-up questions to dig deeper into important details or clarify anything unclear.

Hint:

Effective follow-up questions include:

- "Can you tell me more about...?"
- "What would success look like for this feature?"
- "What concerns do you have about...?"
- "How do you prioritize between [X] and [Y]?"

Exercise 2: Transform interview insights into structured requirements

In this exercise, you will use AI to help organize your interview findings into clear, structured requirements. You will learn to identify key needs and present them in a professional format.

Step 1: Review your interview and identify key themes

1. Read through your interview conversation and identify the most important information, including:

- Business goals mentioned by the stakeholder
- Specific needs or requirements
- Constraints or limitations
- Success criteria

Step 2: Use AI to generate structured requirements

1. Prompt the AI to organize your interview into a clear requirements format.

Example prompt:

Using this interview transcript, create a structured requirements summary with clear sections for business goals, user needs, functional requirements, and constraints.



2. Review the AI's output and verify it captures all important details accurately.

3. If anything seems unclear or missing, prompt the AI to refine or expand specific sections.

Example refinement prompt:

Expand the functional requirements section to include specific user stories or acceptance criteria.



Hint:

Sample requirements structure:

Business Goal	User Need	Functional Requirement	Constraint	Success Criteria
What stakeholder wants to achieve	Who needs this and why	Specific feature or capability	Limitation or requirement	How to measure success

Summary

In this lab, you practiced using AI-driven prompts to simulate stakeholder interviews and transform conversational insights into structured requirements. You learned how to create effective personas, ask targeted questions, and use AI tools to organize information into professional formats. These skills prepare you for real stakeholder conversations by helping you practice your interviewing approach, refine your questions, and develop structured documentation habits.

Remember that the key to successful requirements gathering is asking clear questions, listening carefully to responses, and organizing information in a way that guides project decisions. As you continue to practice these techniques, you'll become more confident in both simulated and real-world stakeholder interactions.

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